

Counsel Packet — Steppe (Trust & Safety · Verification Retention · Governance · COI · Budget)

Prepared 2026-07-08; governance & COI documents added the same day. A consolidated bundle for Oregon nonprofit / platform-liability counsel. **Every document here is DRAFT pending counsel review — none is a legal instrument, and none has force until adopted.**

1. Alignment status: EXECUTED (2026-06-27)

The privacy/terms alignment to the verify-then-forget posture was carried out in two commits, both dated **2026-06-27**:

- **d6db153** — docs(privacy): align /privacy copy with verification-retention posture (edited steppe/messages/en.json + es.json, “privacy” namespace)
- **8f13a3f** — docs(terms): add /legal/terms aligned with the trust & safety posture (added steppe/content/legal/terms.md + the /legal/terms page)

Both surfaces state the posture correctly:

Requirement (decision record §1, §7)	/privacy	/legal/terms
Evidence deleted immediately	✓ “we delete what you sent” / “then delete the proof”	✓ “the proof is deleted the moment that check is made” / “deleted immediately after the residency check”
Retain flag / date / method only	✓ “keep only that you’re verified, the date, and the method”	✓ “we retain only the verified status, the date, and the method”
“Can’t disclose” scoped to verification, not all data	✓ “Because we don’t keep the proof, we can’t produce or disclose it”	✓ same, and explicit that “account details and content within their retention window do exist and may be subject to lawful disclosure”

2. Documents in this packet

Trust & safety / verification retention:

#	Document	Source path	Last commit (content)
01	/privacy page	steppe/app/(site)/privacy/pages + steppe/messages/en.json	d6db153 (2026-06-27); component ae429a (2026-06-22) (“privacy” namespace)
02	/legal/terms page	steppe/content/legal/terms.md	8f13a3f (2026-06-27)
03	Decision record (canon)	docs/decisions/steppe-ts-verification-decision-record.md	bfb4fb4 (2026-07-04)
04	Consent / membership agreement (“Terms of Membership” + Privacy, documents table v0.1, rendered at /welcome)	seed/documents-terms-privacy-v0.1.sql	38ccbc9 (2026-07-08)

Governance & entity (nonprofit / 501(c)(3)):

#	Document	Source path	Status
05	Governance Charter & Bylaws (ORS 65 / intended 501(c)(3); Business Plan v11 basis)	docs/Steppe-Governance-Charter-v0.1-DRAFT.docx	Working Draft v0.1 — NOT YET ADOPTED
06	Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Packet (board + founder disclosures & signable forms)	docs/Steppe-COI-Disclosure-Packet-v1.2.docx	v1.4 (2026-07-08: Chism-Cobb relationship confirmed via Three Canyon; Weimer + IEF spousal disclosure added) — working draft for counsel
07	COI Register	docs/steppe-coi-register-v1.md	7f68e78 (2026-06-27)

05 and 06 are rendered to markdown from Word originals that are intentionally **git-ignored** (.gitignore: *.docx) — so those .docx are not in git history, and this packet’s markdown is the first tracked copy of their content. Formatting (tables, signature blocks) may differ from the Word source; request the .docx originals from the founder for editing/signature.

Note (2026-07-08 review pass): the markdown for 05 (§4.2 verification; §8.9 honoraria note), 06 (revised to **v1.4** — Three Canyon confirmed; Weimer + IEF disclosure added), 07 (**v2** — Entry 002), and 08 (sponsor confirmed IEF + honoraria resolution) was edited in this review pass; the authoritative .docx sources (05, 06) must receive the same edits before signature. Documents 09 (Schedule of Defaults) and 10 (review annex) were added.

Financial:

#	Document	Source path	Last commit
08	Operating Budget (staged; PROPOSED planning numbers, not commitments) — fiscal sponsor Ignite Empowerment Foundation , sponsorship agreement pending signature; companion to Business Plan v12	docs/steppe-operating-budget-v1.md	0daa1f1 (2026-07-04)

Governance norms & review (added 2026-07-08):

#	Document	Source path	Status
09	Schedule of Defaults (member-governed community norms; fills the gap cited in 03 §3 and 02 §2)	docs/Steppe-Schedule-of-Defaults-v0.1.md (new)	Working Draft v0.1 — NOT YET RATIFIED
10	Annex A — Pre-counsel review notes (this pass; findings, punch list, and what’s missing for counsel)	counsel-packet/10-pre-counsel-review-notes.md	Internal review, 2026-07-08

3. Contradictions / discrepancies vs the decision record

One material contradiction (governance/COI), addressed in this pass — see Annex A (10).

- **[06 ↔ 07 — COI financial relationship. RESOLVED 2026-07-08.]** The COI Disclosure Packet (06) had stated there was *no* financial relationship between Greg Chism and Holli Cobb and relied on that to let each approve the other's interested-person transactions; the COI Register (07, Entry 1) disclosed the opposite. **Confirmed:** the relationship is real and held by **Three Canyon Consulting LLC** (paid engagement with Redmond Compass, Director Cobb's company). 06 was revised to **v1.4** and 07 to **v2** — neither director is disinterested as to the other, and a disinterested body independent of **both** is required.
- **[Fiscal sponsor + board independence. New 2026-07-08.]** The sponsor is confirmed as **Ignite Empowerment Foundation (IEF)** (resolving the earlier IEF-vs-Aspiration discrepancy in favor of IEF; the separate privacy-policy draft still says Aspiration and must be updated). **Director Brandon Weimer is the spouse of IEF's founder** — a new related-party conflict (07, Entry 002) that also means Weimer is not the clean independent director previously assumed. With all three directors entangled, **Steppe plans to seat a fourth, fully independent director. [COUNSEL: §4958 approving-body / recusal map; P0.]**

On the verification-retention posture there remain **no hard contradictions**. Two prior notes:

1. **[RESOLVED 2026-07-08]** The consent-gate **Terms of Membership** (documents v0.1) previously enumerated the retained set as *“the fact that you are verified and which method you used”* — omitting the date. Both spots (Terms §3 and Privacy §3) were updated to *“verified, the date, and ... method”* to match the decision record §1 and the aligned pages. `CLAUDE.md` invariant 1 was likewise updated (it had said “profiles.verified + the method”). The documents table body in this packet (04) reflects the corrected text.
2. **[CONTEXT]** The consent-gate documents (v0.1, 2026-06-14) **predate** the June 27 alignment and were **not** part of the alignment commits — but they already carried verify-then-forget language from the start (“We verify, then forget... documents are deleted as soon as we’ve checked them”), so they are **substantively aligned**. They remain DRAFT v0.1 pending legal review; when counsel returns edits, this consent copy must be updated **alongside** the `/legal/*.md` and `/privacy` surfaces so the three don't drift.

Filename note: the request referenced `docs/decisions/trust-safety-verification-retention.md`; the record was filed as `steppe-ts-verification-decision-record.md` (the record itself states the originally-suggested name “was not used”).

4. Reviewer annotations (in 02)

`/legal/terms` carries `[CONFIRM ...]` blockquotes (claims for counsel to verify) and `[BRACKET]` placeholders (specifics to fill: effective date, service area, legal entity). The live page strips `[CONFIRM ...]` and stays **noindex** until every placeholder is filled and counsel signs off.

5. Governance & COI — status for counsel

- **Charter & Bylaws (05)** is a **working draft, not yet adopted** (adoption is under its own Article XII). It carries bracketed items and a Schedule A punch list of decisions still to be confirmed. It is written for revision by the founder and review by qualified Oregon nonprofit counsel — explicitly *not* a legal instrument or legal advice.

- **COI Disclosure Packet (06)** records the conflict-of-interest disclosures of the three individuals in Steppe's founding governance; Parts 2-4 are signable forms with bracketed items to complete before signature. To be finalized by counsel before adoption or signature.

All documents are DRAFT pending Oregon nonprofit / platform-liability counsel review — not legal instruments, no force until adopted. This packet is committed to the repo; the .docx originals behind 05 and 06 are gitignored and are not.